

COURTNEY GERVER, Ph.D.

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Versatile mixed-methods researcher with over a decade of experience driving evidence-based business decisions. Skilled at triangulating research and behavioral metrics to uncover pain points and transform complex user behaviors into compelling narratives that shape product roadmaps, cross-functional strategy, and executive decision-making. Highly collaborative and innovation-forward, with a proven ability to thrive in self-directed environments.

SKILLS

Qualitative Research Methodology: In-depth interviews, focus groups, contextual inquiry, diary studies, cognitive walkthroughs and think-aloud protocols, secondary research

Quantitative Research Methodology: Surveys, experimental design, behavioral analytics, A/B testing, longitudinal studies, meta-analyses

Data Management: Quantitative and qualitative statistical analyses, cleaning, visualization, mining, version control, executive-ready reports and presentations

Tools: UserZoom, Qualtrics, Figma, R, SPSS, Github, Miro, Google Suite, Microsoft Suite

AI Use Cases: Research operations, information synthesis, qualitative analysis, enhanced storytelling, strategic ideation, agentic implementation

EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Technology Innovation Researcher

Dec. 2024-Present

Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company - Remote, USA

- Conduct in-depth research to uncover pain points and unmet needs of associates, translating the Voice of the Associate into data-driven evidence that informs product decisions and behavioral KPIs
- Partner with cross-functional Product, Design, Operations, and Technology teams to lead impactful mixed-methods research initiatives that shape enterprise strategy and drive measurable business outcomes
- Adapt research strategies to address evolving business needs and opportunities, including the responsible adoption, capability prioritization, and enterprise-wide scaling of generative and agentic AI
- Promote the value of research by embedding a behavioral metrics ecosystem across product roadmaps, executive planning, experience maps, and operational reviews to establish data-driven insights as a strategic foundation across 30+ projects
- Transform insights into compelling stories for diverse audiences, balancing a portfolio of projects while hosting a monthly enterprise-wide broadcast that synthesizes findings into a unified narrative guiding technology adoption

Specialist, User Experience Researcher

Mar. 2022-Dec. 2024

Nationwide Mutual Insurance Company - Remote, USA

- Conduct end-to-end research to better understand current and future customers, drive product development, inform key business decisions, and improve customer retention

- Deliver data-driven insights and recommendations representing 1,000+ participants across qualitative and mixed-methods studies to key stakeholders, marketing, and company associates via presentation and internal documentation
- Foster cross-functional collaboration to ensure user-centered insights and design principles are incorporated into key product decisions
- Implement human-centered practices in key technologies such as mobile phones, generative AI, and blockchain
- Present research projects outside of primary product research to associate communities of practice

Graduate Research Scientist

June 2017 - Aug. 2022

The Pennsylvania State University - University Park, PA

- Independently planned, conducted, analyzed, and visualized mixed-methods research data from 17 research projects to examine the neurobiological basis of cognition
- Communicated research findings in 10 empirical research publications, 15 conference presentations, and 3 public community talks with collaborators, project stakeholders, and the general public
- Collected primary and secondary data from 13,500+ online and in-person participants using behavioral experiments, surveys, and fMRI
- Managed multiple multi-site research teams totaling 20+ undergraduate researchers while providing mentorship for career development
- Created open-sourced data processing scripts to increase lab efficiency and quality control

VOLUNTEER WORK

Communications Committee Social Media Manager

Jul. 2023 - Present

Pittsburgh Curling Club

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Cognitive Neuroscience

2022

The Pennsylvania State University

M.S., Cognitive Psychology

2019

The Pennsylvania State University

B.S., Psychology

2017

St. Thomas Aquinas College

Visiting Scholar

Summer 2016

University of Oxford